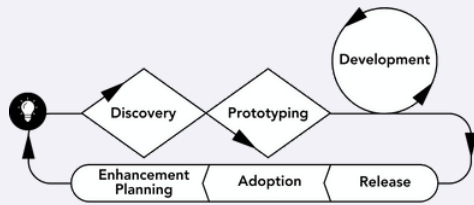


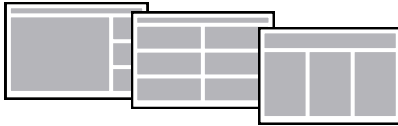
Dashboards That Deliver Design Cheat Sheet



This cheat sheet focuses on the Prototyping and Development stages of the Dashboards That Deliver Framework. Successful dashboards are rooted in knowing your audience; the design decisions outlined below provide the visual structure you can use to translate that into clear, actionable insights.

LAYOUT AND READING ORDER

DESIGN TO A GRID



A clear grid structure creates visual orders and grouping of related features.

CONTENT AND CONTEXT

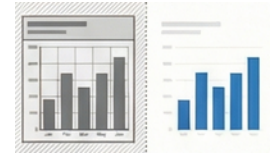
USE BANS



Use Big Ass Numbers (BANS) to prominently display critical metrics.

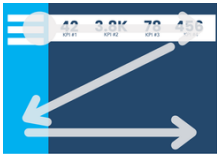
VISUAL DESIGN AND CLARITY

DECLUTTER



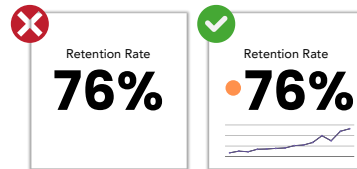
Remove unnecessary visual elements such as borders and gridlines. "As simple as possible, but not simpler"

MOST IMPORTANT INFO ON TOP



Viewers tend to start in the top left of the screen; put your most important info there.

AVOID "LONELY" NUMBERS



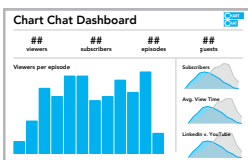
Adding context can greatly improve your BANS. Add arrows, sparklines, dots or similar.

USE COLOUR SPARINGLY



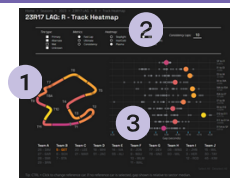
Use a limited colour palette, focusing on one primary colour. Don't use colour for decoration.

CREATE VISUAL GROUPINGS



Use Gestalt principles to create groupings. Light borders and shading are good methods.

"OVERVIEW, ZOOM, DETAILS"



Allow for guided exploration with a flow from overview to details.

DON'T TRUST DEFAULTS



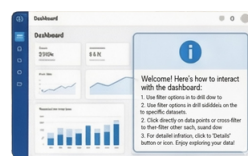
Software tools' defaults are often misleading or cluttered. Take control of every setting.

OPTIMIZE FOR ALL SCREENS



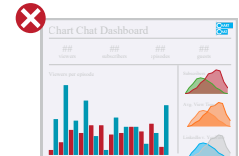
Create specific layouts for mobile. Single scrollable columns work best on mobile.

INSTRUCT YOUR USERS



Ensure users know how to interact with obvious filters, information buttons and/or overlays.

DESIGN FOR ACCESSIBILITY



Accessibility helps everyone. Check colour contrasts, text eligibility and use clear, simple language.

Mastering these principles is the first step toward creating a dashboard that facilitates understanding and drives action. Remember: a great dashboard is an iterative journey. **For more downloadable resources and three free chapters visit DashboardsThatDeliver.com**

